executive responsibilities are assigned by the Constitution to a Council of Ministers led by the Prime Minister, and such Council of Ministers, both collectively and individually responsible and accountable to the union legislature. Thus, our Republican form of State is different from American form of Republic, where it is Presidential executive.

3.2 President

The President is the head of the Indian State. He is the First Citizen of India and acts as the symbol of Unity, Integrity and Solidarity of the Nation.

Qualification and Election of the President

Article 58 says;

1. No person shall be eligible for election as President unless he is
   - ❖ a citizen of India
   - ❖ has completed the age of 35 years
   - ❖ is qualified for election as a member of the Lok Sabha
2. A person shall not be eligible for election as President if he holds any office of profit under the government of India, or the government of any state, or under any local or other authority subject to the control of any of the said governments.

Article 52 of our Constitution lays down that there shall be a President of India. Article 53 lays down that the executive power of the Union shall be vested in the President and shall be exercised by him directly or indirectly.

Further Article 52 provides that the nomination of a candidate for election to the office of President must be subscribed by at least 50 electors as proposers and seconded by another 50 electors of the Electoral College. Every candidate has to make a security deposit of ₹ 15,000/- in the Reserve Bank of India.

This amount will be forefeited if the candidate does not secure 1/6 of the votes polled.

The President is elected not directly by the people but by members of Electoral College consisting of:

- ❖ The elected members of both the houses of Parliament
- ❖ The elected members of the legislative assemblies of the states
- ❖ The elected members of the legislative assemblies of the union territories of Delhi and Pondicherry.

Activity

Find out the electoral quota if the total number of voters polled in the election for President is 10,00,000 and the number of candidates to be elected is 1

The President`s election is held in accordance with the system of proportional representation by means of single transferable vote and the voting is by secret ballot. This system enures that the successful candidate is returned by the absolute majority of votes.

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